



and over the last decade, Meta has open-sourced, shared over a thousand AI databases and models, including very powerful AI models, which help with the automatic translation of many languages, including the numerous languages in India. And recently, we did something that none of the big US tech companies have done so far: We have open-sourced our latest large language model (LLM) called Llama. What does that mean? That means that any academic, any researcher, any developer, any entrepreneur, any budding businessperson here in India—instead of having to build their own LLM at the expense of billions of US dollars—can just download it. It runs directly on Windows... and you can create a new large language, new tools in finance, financial services, and education, health, [among other things]. I think that approach to open innovation is something we've always believed in, and it will really help going forward as well.

Q: Let's shift our attention to Threads. It launched with a lot of hype, but user engagement and daily active users seem to have come down quite a bit from the initial numbers. How do you see Threads playing out?

A: When you get new apps, you always get this eruption of interest; lots of people use it two or three times and then it falls off... And then you get a core base of users and build from that. And we've done that before, multiple times on Instagram, on Facebook with new features. And remember, Threads is a sort of a

work in progress for lots of new features will be added over time.

But why Threads? Because I think there are a lot of people who are looking for a microblogging site where they can share news and views... particularly when it's led by people you admire—creators, influencers and so on; they don't necessarily find Twitter particularly attractive right now and want something that is a slightly kinder alternative. There's space for more than one kind of microblogging site. The interesting thing about Threads is we're building it very, very different to things like Twitter... so that it will become part of something called the fediverse—where you will be able to interoperably share your content on Mastodon, for instance. It'll be a much more open platform where people will be able to share content across different sites.

Q: On the issue of innovation, one of the concerns is that a lot of work Meta has done of late, whether it's Reels, Stories, or Threads seems to have been taken from somewhere where you adopted the ideas and scaled it up, gave it volume, made it successful. But it isn't genuine innovation in the way that OpenAI did, or Apple and Google do. How do you respond to this?

A: I don't think anyone can say that Facebook itself is not one of the most innovative technologies over the last decade... [and our] huge investments in building a new computing platform is something that we're pioneering in a way that nobody else is. And by the way, car manufacturers will look at each other's products; of course, people compare notes and see what is moving and shaking in the market. But look at our big bets—whether they're on social media platforms, the metaverse, or indeed, our long-standing investments in AI well before it became a major talking point. And just to give you an example of that, one of the foundational AI libraries that everybody now uses in the AI industry is called PyTorch—something that Facebook engineers and researchers came up with. I think you can both innovate and, at the same time, look at how people use technology as it evolves. And then evolve yourself, and that's exactly what we do as a company.

Q: You mentioned the need for global regulation. In India, through the data privacy bill, which is going to be introduced, the focus is on data localisation. How do you see the data privacy debate in India shape up?

A: I haven't seen the latest version of the legislation you refer to, but I very much hope that it will not